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### Channel occupancy time (COT) maintenance for sidelink communications in unlicensed bands

#### Abstract

A method of wireless communication performed by a first wireless communication device may maintain a channel occupancy time (COT) in a shared frequency band during at least one physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) instance. In some aspects, the method includes transmitting, in a first portion of a COT based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a PSFCH resource. The method further includes receiving, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol. The method further includes transmitting, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.

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## **Background/Summary**

### **INTRODUCTION**

(1) Wireless communications systems are widely deployed to provide various types of communication content such as voice, video, packet data, messaging, broadcast, and so on. These systems may be capable of supporting communication with multiple users by sharing the available system resources (e.g., time, frequency, and power). A wireless multiple-access communications system may include a number of base stations (BSs), each simultaneously supporting communications for multiple communication devices, which may be otherwise known as user equipment (UE).

(2) To meet the growing demands for expanded mobile broadband connectivity, wireless communication technologies are advancing from the long term evolution (LTE) technology to a next generation new radio (NR) technology, which may be referred to as 5th Generation (5G). For example, NR is designed to provide a lower latency, a higher bandwidth or a higher throughput, and a higher reliability than LTE. NR is designed to operate over a wide array of spectrum bands, for example, from low-frequency bands below about 1 gigahertz (GHz) and mid-frequency bands from about 1 GHz to about 6 GHz, to high-frequency bands such as millimeter wave (mmWave) bands. NR is also designed to operate across different spectrum types, from licensed spectrum to unlicensed and shared spectrum. Spectrum sharing enables operators to opportunistically aggregate spectrums to dynamically support high-bandwidth services. Spectrum sharing can extend the benefit of NR technologies to operating entities that may not have access to a licensed spectrum.

(3) In a wireless communication network, a BS may communicate with a UE in an uplink direction and a downlink direction. Sidelink was introduced in LTE to allow a UE to send data to another UE without tunneling through the BS and/or an associated core network. The LTE sidelink technology had been extended to provision for device-to-device (D2D) communications, vehicle-to-everything (V2X) communications, and/or cellular vehicle-to-everything (C-V2X) communications. Similarly, NR may be extended to support sidelink communications for D2D, V2X, and/or C-V2X over a dedicated spectrum, a licensed spectrum, and/or an unlicensed spectrum.

### **BRIEF SUMMARY OF SOME EXAMPLES**

(4) The following summarizes some aspects of the present disclosure to provide a basic understanding of the discussed technology. This summary is not an extensive overview of all contemplated features of the disclosure and is intended neither to identify key or critical elements of all aspects of the disclosure nor to delineate the scope of any or all aspects of the disclosure. Its sole purpose is to present some concepts of one or more aspects of the disclosure in summary form as a prelude to the more detailed description that is presented later.

(5) According to one aspect of the present disclosure, a method of wireless communication performed by a first wireless communication device includes: transmitting, in a first portion of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resource; receiving, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol; and transmitting, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.

(6) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a method of wireless communication performed by a first wireless communication device includes: performing a listen-before-talk (LBT) to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT); and transmitting, based on the LBT, a first sidelink (SL) communication in the COT, the first SL communication including SL communication information (SCI) and SL data, the COT including SL data resources and SL feedback resources, wherein the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the SL data resources and at least a portion of the SL feedback resources.

(7) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a first wireless communication device includes: a memory; a transceiver; and a processor in communication with the memory and the transceiver, wherein the first wireless communication device is configured to: transmit, in a first portion of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resource; receive, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol; and transmit, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.

(8) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a first wireless communication device includes: a memory; a transceiver; and a processor in communication with the memory and the transceiver, wherein the first wireless communication device is configured to: perform a listen-before-talk (LBT) to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT); and transmit, based on the LBT, a first sidelink (SL) communication in the COT, the first SL communication including SL communication information (SCI) and SL data, the COT including SL data resources and SL feedback resources, wherein the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the SL data resources and at least a portion of the SL feedback resources.

(9) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a non-transitory, computer-readable medium comprises program code recorded thereon, where the program code comprises instructions executable by a processor of a first wireless communication device to cause the first wireless communication device to: transmit, in a first portion of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resource; receive, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol; and transmit, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.

(10) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a non-transitory, computer-readable medium comprises program code recorded thereon, where the program code comprises instructions executable by a processor of a first wireless communication device to cause the first wireless communication device to: perform a listen-before-talk (LBT) to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT); and transmit, based on the LBT, a first sidelink (SL) communication in the COT, the first SL communication including SL communication information (SCI) and SL data, the COT including SL data resources and SL feedback resources, wherein the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the SL data resources and at least a portion of the SL feedback resources.

(11) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a first wireless communication device comprises: means for transmitting, in a first portion of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resource; means for receiving, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol; and means for transmitting, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.

(12) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a first wireless communication device comprises: means for performing a listen-before-talk (LBT) to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT); and means for transmitting, based on the LBT, a first sidelink (SL) communication in the COT, the first SL communication including SL communication information (SCI) and SL data, the COT including SL data resources and SL feedback resources, wherein the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the SL data resources and at least a portion of the SL feedback resources.

(13) Other aspects, features, and embodiments of the present invention will become apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art, upon reviewing the following description of specific, exemplary embodiments of the present invention in conjunction with the accompanying figures. While features of the present invention may be discussed relative to certain embodiments and figures below, all embodiments of the present invention can include one or more of the advantageous features discussed herein. In other words, while one or more embodiments may be discussed as having certain advantageous features, one or more of such features may also be used in accordance with the various embodiments of the invention discussed herein. In similar fashion, while exemplary embodiments may be discussed below as device, system, or method embodiments it should be understood that such exemplary embodiments can be implemented in various devices, systems, and methods.

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## Description

### BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates a wireless communication network according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 illustrates a wireless communication network that provisions for sidelink communications according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 3 illustrates a sidelink communication scheme in a wireless communication network according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 4 is a timing diagram illustrating a sidelink communication scenario, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 5 is a timing diagram illustrating a scheme for maintaining a channel occupancy time (COT) for sidelink communications in a shared frequency band, according to aspects of the present disclosure.

- (6) FIG. 6 is a signaling diagram illustrating a method for maintaining a COT for sidelink communications in a shared frequency band, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 7 is a flow diagram illustrating a scheme for maintaining a COT for sidelink communications in a shared frequency band, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 8 is a signaling diagram illustrating a method for maintaining a COT for sidelink communications in a shared frequency band, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (9) FIG. 9A is a timing diagram illustrating a sidelink communication scenario, according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (10) FIG. 9B is a timing diagram illustrating a scheme for maintaining a COT for sidelink communications in a shared frequency band, according to aspects of the present disclosure.
- (11) FIG. 10 is a block diagram of a user equipment (UE) according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (12) FIG. 11 is a block diagram of an exemplary base station (BS) according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (13) FIG. 12 is a flow diagram of a sidelink communication method according to some aspects of the present disclosure.
- (14) FIG. 13 is a flow diagram of a sidelink communication method according to some aspects of the present disclosure.

#### DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (15) The detailed description set forth below, in connection with the appended drawings, is intended as a description of various configurations and is not intended to represent the only configurations in which the concepts described herein may be practiced. The detailed description includes specific details for the purpose of providing a thorough understanding of the various concepts. However, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art that these concepts may be practiced without these specific details. In some instances, well-known structures and components are shown in block diagram form in order to avoid obscuring such concepts.
- (16) This disclosure relates generally to wireless communications systems, also referred to as wireless communications networks. In various aspect, the techniques and apparatus may be used for wireless communication networks such as code division multiple access (CDMA) networks, time division multiple access (TDMA) networks, frequency division multiple access (FDMA) networks, orthogonal FDMA (OFDMA) networks, single-carrier FDMA (SC-FDMA) networks, LTE networks, Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM) networks, 5th Generation (5G) or new radio (NR) networks, as well as other communications networks. As described herein, the terms “networks” and “systems” may be used interchangeably.
- (17) An OFDMA network may implement a radio technology such as evolved UTRA (E-UTRA), Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.11, IEEE 802.16, IEEE 802.20, flash-OFDM and the like. UTRA, E-UTRA, and GSM are part of universal mobile telecommunication system (UMTS). In particular, long term evolution (LTE) is a release of UMTS that uses E-UTRA. UTRA, E-UTRA, GSM, UMTS and LTE are described in documents provided from an organization named “3rd Generation Partnership Project” (3GPP), and cdma2000 is described in documents from an organization named “3rd Generation Partnership Project 2” (3GPP2). These various radio technologies and standards are known or are being developed. For example, the 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) is a collaboration between groups of telecommunications associations that aims to define a globally applicable third generation (3G) mobile phone specification. 3GPP long term evolution (LTE) is a 3GPP project which was aimed at improving the UMTS mobile phone standard. The 3GPP may define specifications for the next generation of mobile networks, mobile systems, and mobile devices. The present disclosure is concerned with the evolution of wireless technologies from LTE, 4G, 5G, NR, and beyond with shared access to wireless spectrum between networks using a collection of new and different radio access technologies or radio air interfaces.

(18) 5G networks contemplate diverse deployments, diverse spectrum, and diverse services and devices that may be implemented using an OFDM-based unified, air interface. In order to achieve these goals, further enhancements to LTE and LTE-A are considered in addition to development of the new radio technology for 5G NR networks. The 5G NR will be capable of scaling to provide coverage (1) to a massive Internet of things (IoTs) with a ultra-high density (e.g.,  $\sim 10^6$  nodes/km<sup>2</sup>), ultra-low complexity (e.g.,  $\sim 10$  s of bits/sec), ultra-low energy (e.g.,  $\sim 10+$  years of battery life), and deep coverage with the capability to reach challenging locations; (2) including mission-critical control with strong security to safeguard sensitive personal, financial, or classified information, ultra-high reliability (e.g.,  $\sim 99.9999\%$  reliability), ultra-low latency (e.g.,  $\sim 1$  ms), and users with wide ranges of mobility or lack thereof; and (3) with enhanced mobile broadband including extreme high capacity (e.g.,  $\sim 10$  Tbps/km<sup>2</sup>), extreme data rates (e.g., multi-Gbps rate, 100+ Mbps user experienced rates), and deep awareness with advanced discovery and optimizations.

(19) The 5G NR may be implemented to use optimized OFDM-based waveforms with scalable numerology and transmission time interval (TTI); having a common, flexible framework to efficiently multiplex services and features with a dynamic, low-latency time division duplex (TDD)/frequency division duplex (FDD) design; and with advanced wireless technologies, such as massive multiple input, multiple output (MIMO), robust millimeter wave (mmWave) transmissions, advanced channel coding, and device-centric mobility. Scalability of the numerology in 5G NR, with scaling of subcarrier spacing, may efficiently address operating diverse services across diverse spectrum and diverse deployments. For example, in various outdoor and macro coverage deployments of less than 3 GHz FDD/TDD implementations, subcarrier spacing may occur with 15 kHz, for example over 5, 10, 20 MHz, and the like bandwidth (BW). For other various outdoor and small cell coverage deployments of TDD greater than 3 GHz, subcarrier spacing may occur with 30 kHz over 80/100 MHz BW. For other various indoor wideband implementations, using a TDD over the unlicensed portion of the 5 GHz band, the subcarrier spacing may occur with 60 kHz over a 160 MHz BW. Finally, for various deployments transmitting with mmWave components at a TDD of 28 GHz, subcarrier spacing may occur with 120 kHz over a 500 MHz BW.

(20) The scalable numerology of the 5G NR facilitates scalable TTI for diverse latency and quality of service (QoS) requirements. For example, shorter TTI may be used for low latency and high reliability, while longer TTI may be used for higher spectral efficiency. The efficient multiplexing of long and short TTIs to allow transmissions to start on symbol boundaries. 5G NR also contemplates a self-contained integrated subframe design with UL/downlink scheduling information, data, and acknowledgement in the same subframe. The self-contained integrated subframe supports communications in unlicensed or contention-based shared spectrum, adaptive UL/downlink that may be flexibly configured on a per-cell basis to dynamically switch between UL and downlink to meet the current traffic needs.

(21) Various other aspects and features of the disclosure are further described below. It should be apparent that the teachings herein may be embodied in a wide variety of forms and that any specific structure, function, or both being disclosed herein is merely representative and not limiting. Based on the teachings herein one of an ordinary level of skill in the art should appreciate that an aspect disclosed herein may be implemented independently of any other aspects and that two or more of these aspects may be combined in various ways. For example, an apparatus may be implemented or a method may be practiced using any number of the aspects set forth herein. In addition, such an apparatus may be implemented or such a method may be practiced using other structure, functionality, or structure and functionality in addition to or other than one or more of the aspects set forth herein. For example, a method may be implemented as part of a system, device, apparatus, and/or as instructions stored on a computer readable medium for execution on a processor or computer. Furthermore, an aspect may comprise at least one element of a claim.

(22) Sidelink communication refers to the communications among user equipment devices (UEs) without tunneling through a base station (BS) and/or a core network. Sidelink communication can be communicated over a physical sidelink control channel (PSCCH) and a physical sidelink shared channel (PSSCH). The PSCCH and PSSCH are analogous to a physical downlink control channel (PDCCH) and a physical downlink shared channel (PDSCH) in downlink (DL) communication between a BS and a UE. For instance, the PSCCH may carry sidelink control information (SCI) and the PSSCH may carry sidelink data (e.g., user data). Each PSCCH is associated with a corresponding PSSCH, where SCI in a PSCCH may carry reservation and/or scheduling information for sidelink data transmission in the associated PSSCH. Use cases for sidelink communication may include vehicle-to-everything (V2X), industrial IoT (IIoT), and/or NR-lite.

(23) UEs communicating using a sidelink interface may be configured to respond to sidelink communications from other UEs with hybrid automatic repeat request (HARQ) feedback indicating whether one or more sidelink transport blocks (TBs) were successfully received or not. In some aspects, the UEs may be configured with sidelink feedback resources mapped to one or more SL data resources. For example, the UEs may be configured with physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resources. The PSFCH resources may include one or more periodic PSFCH instances. Each PSFCH instance may be associated with a PSFCH period including one or more slots. In some aspect, the UEs may communicate at least one PSSCH communication in each slot. Further, the UEs may be configured to communicate using shared or unlicensed frequency resources. These communications may be referred to as sidelink-unlicensed (SL-U). To communicate in the shared or unlicensed frequency resources, one or more UEs may perform a clear channel assessment (CCA). For example, a UE may perform a listen-before-talk (LBT) procedure by obtaining channel measurements for a fixed or variable amount of time. If the channel measurements fall below a configured threshold, the UE may initiate or acquire a channel occupancy time (COT) to communicate with one or more other UEs. In some aspects, communications from one UE to another specific UE may be referred to as unicast communications. Communications from one or more UEs to one or more other UEs may be referred to as groupcast or multicast communications.

(24) Each acquired COT may provide a limited amount of time to transmit and/or receive SL communications. For example, each COT may include one or more slots, where each slot comprises a plurality of symbols allocated for different types of SL signals and/or data. For example, each slot may include one or more portions allocated for SCI, and one or more portions allocated for SL data. Further, the UEs may be configured with periodic PSFCH resources which may have a periodicity of one slot or more than one slot. In some aspects, the UEs may be configured with one or more gap symbols between a SL data portion and a PSFCH resource. In this regard, in some aspects, communicating PSFCH information may involve a switch in link direction (e.g., transmit to receive, receive to transmit). However, wireless communication devices using shared or unlicensed frequency resources may operate based on requirements of continuity during the COT. For example, if a UE refrains from communications for more than a configured duration during the COT, the UE may be prevented from continuing communications in the COT after the gap. In some instances, the configured duration may be about 16 microseconds ( $\mu\text{s}$ ). In other instances, the configured duration may be about 25  $\mu\text{s}$ . However, the duration of a single symbol may be more than 25  $\mu\text{s}$ . Accordingly, if a PSFCH resource includes a configured gap symbol, and the PSFCH resource is scheduled in the middle of a COT where there is a burst of SL transmissions and/or receptions, the UE may be prevented from continuation communications in the COT after a PSFCH instance.

(25) The present disclosure provides systems, schemes, and mechanisms for maintaining COTs for sidelink communications in shared frequency bands. In some aspects, mechanisms for maintaining COTs include a first wireless communication device indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one symbol between a sidelink communication channel and a sidelink feedback instance. In some aspects, the sidelink feedback instance may be a PSFCH



instance. In some aspects, the signal may include a cyclic prefix (CP). In another aspect, the signal may include an extension of a CP. The extension may be referred to as a CP extension (CPE). In some aspects, transmitting the signal may include transmitting sidelink ACK/NACK in a PSFCH instance with a CPE extending at least partially within the at least one gap symbol. The second wireless communication device may transmit the signal in the at least one gap symbol such that a remaining gap between a PSSCH and a PSFCH communication is less than 25  $\mu$ s. In another aspect, the second wireless communication device may transmit the signal such that the gap between the PSSCH and the PSFCH is less than about 16  $\mu$ s. According to another aspect of the present disclosure, the first wireless communication device may indicate the second wireless communication device to transmit a filler signal or pattern signal in the at least one PSF see instance. For example, in some instances, the first wireless communication device may not expect to receive PSFCH communications from the second wireless communication device. Further, the first wireless communication device may not have sidelink feedback data to communicate in the PSFCH instance. Accordingly, the first wireless communication device may indicate the second wireless communication device to transmit the padding signal, where the padding signal is based on a PSFCH waveform. In some aspects, transmitting the padding signal may include transmitting a CPE with the PSFCH-based padding signal. In some aspects, the CPE may be transmitted in at least one gap symbol between the PSSCH and the PSFCH instance. According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a mechanism for maintaining a COT may include rate matching sidelink data to extend over the at least one gap symbol and/or the PSFCH instance.

(26) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a first wireless communication device may rate match a sidelink communication to extend at least partially over a PSFCH resource. For example, the first wireless communication device may be configured to rate match a PSSCH communication to extend over at least one gap symbol, at least one AGC symbol, and/or at least one PSFCH symbol such that a gap between the end of the rate-matched first SL communication and the beginning of a second SL communication in the following slot is less than a configured COT maintenance threshold.

(27) Aspects of the present disclosure can provide several benefits. For example, by allowing multiple mechanisms for closing gap periods associated with PSFCH resources, one or more UEs communicating in a sidelink network may utilize greater portions of acquired COTs to make more efficient use of the shared frequency resources. Further, by facilitating more continuous sidelink communications in the shared frequency resources, the chance of collisions and/or interference may decrease. Thus, the error rate may also decrease, which can increase network speeds and reduce overhead, leading to an improved user experience. While the present disclosure is described in the context of deploying autonomous sidelink communication over a 2.4 GHz unlicensed band, the disclosed aspect can be applied to any suitable shared or unlicensed band.

(28) FIG. 1 illustrates a wireless communication network **100** according to some aspects of the present disclosure. The network **100** may be a 5G network. The network **100** includes a number of base stations (BSs) **105** (individually labeled as **105a**, **105b**, **105c**, **105d**, **105e**, and **105f**) and other network entities. A BS **105** may be a station that communicates with UEs **115** and may also be referred to as an evolved node B (eNB), a next generation eNB (gNB), an access point, and the like. Each BS **105** may provide communication coverage for a particular geographic area. In 3GPP, the term “cell” can refer to this particular geographic coverage area of a BS **105** and/or a BS subsystem serving the coverage area, depending on the context in which the term is used.

(29) A BS **105** may provide communication coverage for a macro cell or a small cell, such as a pico cell or a femto cell, and/or other types of cell. A macro cell generally covers a relatively large geographic area (e.g., several kilometers in radius) and may allow unrestricted access by UEs with service subscriptions with the network provider. A small cell, such as a pico cell, would generally cover a relatively smaller geographic area and may allow unrestricted access by UEs with service subscriptions with the network provider. A small cell, such as a femto cell, would also generally

cover a relatively small geographic area (e.g., a home) and, in addition to unrestricted access, may also provide restricted access by UEs having an association with the femto cell (e.g., UEs in a closed subscriber group (CSG), UEs for users in the home, and the like). A BS for a macro cell may be referred to as a macro BS. A BS for a small cell may be referred to as a small cell BS, a pico BS, a femto BS or a home BS. In the example shown in FIG. 1, the BSs **105d** and **105e** may be regular macro BSs, while the BSs **105a-105c** may be macro BSs enabled with one of three dimension (3D), full dimension (PD), or massive MIMO. The BSs **105a-105c** may take advantage of their higher dimension MIMO capabilities to exploit 3D beamforming in both elevation and azimuth beamforming to increase coverage and capacity. The BS **105f** may be a small cell BS which may be a home node or portable access point. A BS **105** may support one or multiple (e.g., two, three, four, and the like) cells.

(30) The network **100** may support synchronous or asynchronous operation. For synchronous operation, the BSs may have similar frame timing, and transmissions from different BSs may be approximately aligned in time. For asynchronous operation, the BSs may have different frame timing, and transmissions from different BSs may not be aligned in time.

(31) The UEs **115** are dispersed throughout the wireless network **100**, and each UE **115** may be stationary or mobile. A UE **115** may also be referred to as a terminal, a mobile station, a subscriber unit, a station, or the like. A UE **115** may be a cellular phone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a wireless modem, a wireless communication device, a handheld device, a tablet computer, a laptop computer, a cordless phone, a wireless local loop (WLL) station, or the like. In one aspect, a UE **115** may be a device that includes a Universal Integrated Circuit Card (UICC). In another aspect, a UE may be a device that does not include a UICC. In some aspects, the UEs **115** that do not include UICCs may also be referred to as IoT devices or internet of everything (IoE) devices. The UEs **115a-115d** are examples of mobile smart phone-type devices accessing network **100**. A UE **115** may also be a machine specifically configured for connected communication, including machine type communication (MTC), enhanced MTC (eMTC), narrowband IoT (NB-IoT) and the like. The UEs **115e-115h** are examples of various machines configured for communication that access the network **100**. The UEs **115i-115k** are examples of vehicles equipped with wireless communication devices configured for communication that access the network **100**. A UE **115** may be able to communicate with any type of the BSs, whether macro BS, small cell, or the like. In FIG. 1, a lightning bolt (e.g., communication links) indicates wireless transmissions between a UE **115** and a serving BS **105**, which is a BS designated to serve the UE **115** on the downlink (DL) and/or uplink (UL), desired transmission between BSs **105**, backhaul transmissions between BSs, or sidelink transmissions between UEs **115**.

(32) In operation, the BSs **105a-105c** may serve the UEs **115a** and **115b** using 3D beamforming and coordinated spatial techniques, such as coordinated multipoint (CoMP) or multi-connectivity. The macro BS **105d** may perform backhaul communications with the BSs **105a-105c**, as well as small cell, the BS **105f**. The macro BS **105d** may also transmits multicast services which are subscribed to and received by the UEs **115c** and **115d**. Such multicast services may include mobile television or stream video, or may include other services for providing community information, such as weather emergencies or alerts, such as Amber alerts or gray alerts.

(33) The BSs **105** may also communicate with a core network. The core network may provide user authentication, access authorization, tracking, Internet Protocol (IP) connectivity, and other access, routing, or mobility functions. At least some of the BSs **105** (e.g., which may be an example of a gNB or an access node controller (ANC)) may interface with the core network through backhaul links (e.g., NG-C, NG-U, etc.) and may perform radio configuration and scheduling for communication with the UEs **115**. In various examples, the BSs **105** may communicate, either directly or indirectly (e.g., through core network), with each other over backhaul links (e.g., X1, X2, etc.), which may be wired or wireless communication links.

(34) The network **100** may also support mission critical communications with ultra-reliable and

redundant links for mission critical devices, such as the UE **115e**, which may be a drone.

Redundant communication links with the UE **115e** may include links from the macro BSs **105d** and **105e**, as well as links from the small cell BS **105f**. Other machine type devices, such as the UE **115f** (e.g., a thermometer), the UE **115g** (e.g., smart meter), and UE **115h** (e.g., wearable device) may communicate through the network **100** either directly with BSs, such as the small cell BS **105f**, and the macro BS **105e**, or in multi-step-size configurations by communicating with another user device which relays its information to the network, such as the UE **115f** communicating temperature measurement information to the smart meter, the UE **115g**, which is then reported to the network through the small cell BS **105f**. The network **100** may also provide additional network efficiency through dynamic, low-latency TDD/FDD communications, such as V2V, V2X, C-V2X communications between a UE **115i**, **115j**, or **115k** and other UEs **115**, and/or vehicle-to-infrastructure (V2I) communications between a UE **115i**, **115j**, or **115k** and a BS **105**.

(35) In some implementations, the network **100** utilizes OFDM-based waveforms for communications. An OFDM-based system may partition the system BW into multiple (K) orthogonal subcarriers, which are also commonly referred to as subcarriers, tones, bins, or the like. Each subcarrier may be modulated with data. In some instances, the subcarrier spacing between adjacent subcarriers may be fixed, and the total number of subcarriers (K) may be dependent on the system BW. The system BW may also be partitioned into subbands. In other instances, the subcarrier spacing and/or the duration of TTIs may be scalable.

(36) In some aspects, the BSs **105** can assign or schedule transmission resources (e.g., in the form of time-frequency resource blocks (RB)) for downlink (DL) and uplink (UL) transmissions in the network **100**. DL refers to the transmission direction from a BS **105** to a UE **115**, whereas UL refers to the transmission direction from a UE **115** to a BS **105**. The communication can be in the form of radio frames. A radio frame may be divided into a plurality of subframes or slots, for example, about 10. Each slot may be further divided into mini-slots. In a FDD mode, simultaneous UL and DL transmissions may occur in different frequency bands. For example, each subframe includes a UL subframe in a UL frequency band and a DL subframe in a DL frequency band. In a TDD mode, UL and DL transmissions occur at different time periods using the same frequency band. For example, a subset of the subframes (e.g., DL subframes) in a radio frame may be used for DL transmissions and another subset of the subframes (e.g., UL subframes) in the radio frame may be used for UL transmissions.

(37) The DL subframes and the UL subframes can be further divided into several regions. For example, each DL or UL subframe may have pre-defined regions for transmissions of reference signals, control information, and data. Reference signals are predetermined signals that facilitate the communications between the BSs **105** and the UEs **115**. For example, a reference signal can have a particular pilot pattern or structure, where pilot tones may span across an operational BW or frequency band, each positioned at a pre-defined time and a pre-defined frequency. For example, a BS **105** may transmit cell specific reference signals (CRSs) and/or channel state information—reference signals (CSI-RSs) to enable a UE **115** to estimate a DL channel. Similarly, a UE **115** may transmit sounding reference signals (SRSs) to enable a BS **105** to estimate a UL channel. Control information may include resource assignments and protocol controls. Data may include protocol data and/or operational data. In some aspects, the BSs **105** and the UEs **115** may communicate using self-contained subframes. A self-contained subframe may include a portion for DL communication and a portion for UL communication. A self-contained subframe can be DL-centric or UL-centric. A DL-centric subframe may include a longer duration for DL communication than for UL communication. A UL-centric subframe may include a longer duration for UL communication than for UL communication.

(38) In some aspects, the network **100** may be an NR network deployed over a licensed spectrum. The BSs **105** can transmit synchronization signals (e.g., including a primary synchronization signal (PSS) and a secondary synchronization signal (SSS)) in the network **100** to facilitate

synchronization. The BSs **105** can broadcast system information associated with the network **100** (e.g., including a master information block (MIB), remaining system information (RMSI), and other system information (OSI)) to facilitate initial network access. In some instances, the BSs **105** may broadcast the PSS, the SSS, and/or the MIB in the form of synchronization signal block (SSBs) over a physical broadcast channel (PBCH) and may broadcast the RMSI and/or the OSI over a physical downlink shared channel (PDSCH).

(39) In some aspects, a UE **115** attempting to access the network **100** may perform an initial cell search by detecting a PSS from a BS **105**. The PSS may enable synchronization of period timing and may indicate a physical layer identity value. The UE **115** may then receive a SSS. The SSS may enable radio frame synchronization, and may provide a cell identity value, which may be combined with the physical layer identity value to identify the cell. The PSS and the SSS may be located in a central portion of a carrier or any suitable frequencies within the carrier.

(40) After receiving the PSS and SSS, the UE **115** may receive a MIB. The MIB may include system information for initial network access and scheduling information for RMSI and/or OSI. After decoding the MIB, the UE **115** may receive RMSI and/or OSI. The RMSI and/or OSI may include radio resource control (RRC) information related to random access channel (RACH) procedures, paging, control resource set (CORESET) for physical downlink control channel (PDCCH) monitoring, physical UL control channel (PUCCH), physical UL shared channel (PUSCH), power control, and SRS.

(41) After obtaining the MIB, the RMSI and/or the OSI, the UE **115** can perform a random access procedure to establish a connection with the BS **105**. In some examples, the random access procedure may be a four-step random access procedure. For example, the UE **115** may transmit a random access preamble and the BS **105** may respond with a random access response. The random access response (RAR) may include a detected random access preamble identifier (ID) corresponding to the random access preamble, timing advance (TA) information, a UL grant, a temporary cell-radio network temporary identifier (C-RNTI), and/or a backoff indicator. Upon receiving the random access response, the UE **115** may transmit a connection request to the BS **105** and the BS **105** may respond with a connection response. The connection response may indicate a contention resolution. In some examples, the random access preamble, the RAR, the connection request, and the connection response can be referred to as message 1 (MSG1), message 2 (MSG2), message 3 (MSG3), and message 4 (MSG4), respectively. In some examples, the random access procedure may be a two-step random access procedure, where the UE **115** may transmit a random access preamble and a connection request in a single transmission and the BS **105** may respond by transmitting a random access response and a connection response in a single transmission.

(42) After establishing a connection, the UE **115** and the BS **105** can enter a normal operation stage, where operational data may be exchanged. For example, the BS **105** may schedule the UE **115** for UL and/or DL communications. The BS **105** may transmit UL and/or DL scheduling grants to the UE **115** via a PDCCH. The scheduling grants may be transmitted in the form of DL control information (DCI). The BS **105** may transmit a DL communication signal (e.g., carrying data) to the UE **115** via a PDSCH according to a DL scheduling grant. The UE **115** may transmit a UL communication signal to the BS **105** via a PUSCH and/or PUCCH according to a UL scheduling grant.

(43) In some aspects, the BS **105** may communicate with a UE **115** using HARQ techniques to improve communication reliability, for example, to provide a URLLC service. The BS **105** may schedule a UE **115** for a PDSCH communication by transmitting a DL grant in a PDCCH. The BS **105** may transmit a DL data packet to the UE **115** according to the schedule in the PDSCH. The DL data packet may be transmitted in the form of a transport block (TB). If the UE **115** receives the DL data packet successfully, the UE **115** may transmit a HARQ ACK to the BS **105**. Conversely, if the UE **115** fails to receive the DL transmission successfully, the UE **115** may transmit a HARQ NACK to the BS **105**. Upon receiving a HARQ NACK from the UE **115**, the BS **105** may retransmit the

DL data packet to the UE **115**. The retransmission may include the same coded version of DL data as the initial transmission. Alternatively, the retransmission may include a different coded version of the DL data than the initial transmission. The UE **115** may apply soft-combining to combine the encoded data received from the initial transmission and the retransmission for decoding. The BS **105** and the UE **115** may also apply HARQ for UL communications using substantially similar mechanisms as the DL HARQ.

(44) In some aspects, the network **100** may operate over a system BW or a component carrier (CC) BW. The network **100** may partition the system BW into multiple BWPs (e.g., portions). A BS **105** may dynamically assign a UE **115** to operate over a certain BWP (e.g., a certain portion of the system BW). The assigned BWP may be referred to as the active BWP. The UE **115** may monitor the active BWP for signaling information from the BS **105**. The BS **105** may schedule the UE **115** for UL or DL communications in the active BWP. In some aspects, a BS **105** may assign a pair of BWPs within the CC to a UE **115** for UL and DL communications. For example, the BWP pair may include one BWP for UL communications and one BWP for DL communications.

(45) In some aspects, the network **100** may operate over a shared channel, which may include shared frequency bands and/or unlicensed frequency bands. For example, the network **100** may be an NR-U network operating over an unlicensed frequency band. In such an aspect, the BSs **105** and the UEs **115** may be operated by multiple network operating entities. To avoid collisions, the BSs **105** and the UEs **115** may employ a listen-before-talk (LBT) procedure to monitor for transmission opportunities (TXOPs) in the shared channel. A TXOP may also be referred to as COT. For example, a transmitting node (e.g., a BS **105** or a UE **115**) may perform an LBT prior to transmitting in the channel. When the LBT passes, the transmitting node may proceed with the transmission. When the LBT fails, the transmitting node may refrain from transmitting in the channel.

(46) An LBT can be based on energy detection (ED) or signal detection. For an energy detection-based LBT, the LBT results in a pass when signal energy measured from the channel is below a threshold. Conversely, the LBT results in a failure when signal energy measured from the channel exceeds the threshold. For a signal detection-based LBT, the LBT results in a pass when a channel reservation signal (e.g., a predetermined preamble signal) is not detected in the channel. Additionally, an LBT may be in a variety of modes. An LBT mode may be, for example, a category 4 (CAT4) LBT, a category 2 (CAT2) LBT, or a category 1 (CAT1) LBT. A CAT1 LBT is referred to as a no LBT mode, where no LBT is to be performed prior to a transmission. A CAT2 LBT refers to an LBT without a random backoff period. For instance, a transmitting node may determine a channel measurement in a time interval and determine whether the channel is available or not based on a comparison of the channel measurement against an ED threshold. A CAT4 LBT refers to an LBT with a random backoff and a variable contention window (CW). For instance, a transmitting node may draw a random number and backoff for a duration based on the drawn random number in a certain time unit.

(47) In some aspects, the network **100** may support sidelink communication among the UEs **115** over a shared radio frequency band (e.g., in a shared spectrum or an unlicensed spectrum). In some aspects, the UEs **115** may communicate with each other over a 2.4 GHz unlicensed band, which may be shared by multiple network operating entities using various radio access technologies (RATs) such as NR-U, WiFi, and/or licensed-assisted access (LAA) as shown in FIG. 2.

(48) FIG. 2 illustrates an example of a wireless communication network **200** that provisions for sidelink communications according to aspect of the present disclosure. The network **200** may correspond to a portion of the network **100**. FIG. 2 illustrates two BSs **205** (shown as **205a** and **205b**) and six UEs **215** (shown as **215a1**, **215a2**, **215a3**, **215a4**, **215b1**, and **215b2**) for purposes of simplicity of discussion, though it will be recognized that aspect of the present disclosure may scale to any suitable number of UEs **215** (e.g., the about 2, 3, 4, 5, 7 or more) and/or BSs **205** (e.g., the about 1, 3 or more). The BS **205** and the UEs **215** may be similar to the BSs **105** and the UEs

**115**, respectively. The BSs **205** and the UEs **215** may share the same radio frequency band for communications. In some instances, the radio frequency band may be a 2.4 GHz unlicensed band, a 5 GHz unlicensed band, or a 6 GHz unlicensed band. In general, the shared radio frequency band may be at any suitable frequency.

(49) The BS **205a** and the UEs **215a1-215a4** may be operated by a first network operating entity. The BS **205b** and the UEs **215b1-215b2** may be operated by a second network operating entity. In some aspects, the first network operating entity may utilize a same RAT as the second network operating entity. For instance, the BS **205a** and the UEs **215a1-215a4** of the first network operating entity and the BS **205b** and the UEs **215b1-215b2** of the second network operating entity are NR-U devices. In some other aspects, the first network operating entity may utilize a different RAT than the second network operating entity. For instance, the BS **205a** and the UEs **215a1-215a4** of the first network operating entity may utilize NR-U technology while the BS **205b** and the UEs **215b1-215b2** of the second network operating entity may utilize WiFi or LAA technology.

(50) In the network **200**, some of the UEs **215a1-215a4** may communicate with each other in peer-to-peer communications. For example, the UE **215a1** may communicate with the UE **215a2** over a sidelink **252**, the UE **215a3** may communicate with the UE **215a4** over another sidelink **251**, and the UE **215b1** may communicate with the UE **215b2** over yet another sidelink **254**. The sidelinks **251**, **252**, and **254** are unicast bidirectional links. Some of the UEs **215** may also communicate with the BS **205a** or the BS **205b** in a UL direction and/or a DL direction via communication links **253**. For instance, the UE **215a1**, **215a3**, and **215a4** are within a coverage area **210** of the BS **205a**, and thus may be in communication with the BS **205a**. The UE **215a2** is outside the coverage area **210**, and thus may not be in direct communication with the BS **205a**. In some instances, the UE **215a1** may operate as a relay for the UE **215a2** to reach the BS **205a**. Similarly, the UE **215b1** is within a coverage area **212** of the BS **205b**, and thus may be in communication with the BS **205b** and may operate as a relay for the UE **215b2** to reach the BS **205b**. In some aspects, some of the UEs **215** are associated with vehicles (e.g., similar to the UEs **115i-k**) and the communications over the sidelinks **251**, **252**, and **254** may be C-V2X communications. C-V2X communications may refer to communications between vehicles and any other wireless communication devices in a cellular network.

(51) FIG. 3 illustrates a sidelink communication scheme **300** in a wireless communication network according to some aspects of the present disclosure. The scheme **300** may be employed by UEs such as the UEs **115** and/or **215** in a network such as the networks **100** and/or **200**. In particular, sidelink UEs may employ the scheme **300** to contend for access in a shared radio frequency band (e.g., in a shared spectrum or an unlicensed spectrum) for sidelink communication. The shared radio frequency band may be shared by multiple RATs as discussed in FIG. 2. In FIG. 3, the x-axis represents time in some arbitrary units, and the y-axis represents frequency in some arbitrary units.

(52) In scheme **300**, a shared radio frequency band **301** is partitioned into a plurality of subchannels or frequency subbands **302** (shown as **302.sub.S0**, **302.sub.S1**, **302.sub.S2**, . . . ) for sidelink communication. The frequency band **301** may be at any suitable frequencies. In some instances, the frequency band **301** is a 2.4 GHz unlicensed band. In some instances, the frequency band **301** is a 5 GHz unlicensed band. In some instances, the frequency band **301** is a 6 GHz unlicensed band. The frequency band **301** may have any suitable BW and may be partitioned into any suitable number of frequency subbands **302**. The number of frequency subbands **302** can be dependent on the sidelink communication BW requirement. In some aspects, the frequency band **301** is a 2.4 GHz unlicensed band and may have a bandwidth of about 80 megahertz (MHz) partitioned into about fifteen 5 MHz frequency subbands **302**.

(53) A sidelink UE (e.g., the UEs **115** and/or **215**) may be equipped with a wideband receiver and a narrowband transmitter. For instance, the UE may utilize the narrowband transmitter to access a frequency subband **302.sub.S2** for sidelink transmission utilizing a frame structure **304**. The frame structure **304** is repeated in each frequency subband **302**. In some instances, there can be a

frequency gap or guard band between adjacent frequency subbands **302** as shown in FIG. 3, for example, to mitigate adjacent band interference. Thus, multiple sidelink data may be communicated simultaneously in different frequency subbands **302** (e.g., FDM). The frame structure **304** is also repeated in time. For instance, the frequency subband **302.sub.S2** may be time-partitioned into a plurality of frames with the frame structure **304**. The frame structure **304** includes an LBT gap duration **310** followed by a sidelink resource **306**. The LBT gap duration **310** is used for channel contention among devices of the same RAT or among devices of different RATs. Upon winning contention, the sidelink UE may utilize the sidelink resource **306** for transmission of control and user data.

(54) The sidelink resource **306** may have a substantially similar structure as an NR sidelink resource. For instance, the sidelink resource **306** may include a number of subcarriers or RBs in frequency and a number of symbols in time. In some instances, the sidelink resource **306** may have a duration between about one millisecond (ms) to about 20 ms. The sidelink resource **306** may include a PSCCH **320**, a PSSCH **330**, and/or a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) **340**. The PSCCH **320**, the PSSCH **330**, and the PSFCH **340** can be multiplexed in time and/or frequency. In the illustrated example of FIG. 3, the PSCCH **320** is located during the beginning symbol(s) (e.g., about 1 symbol or about 2 symbols) of the sidelink resource **306** and occupies a portion of the frequency subband **302.sub.S2**. The PSFCH **340** is located at the ending symbol(s) of the sidelink resource **306**. The PSSCH **330** occupies the remaining time-frequency resources in the sidelink resource **306**. In general, the PSCCH **320**, the PSSCH **330**, and the PSFCH **340** may be multiplexed in any suitable configuration within the sidelink resource **306**.

(55) A sidelink UE (e.g., the UEs **115** and/or **215**) intending to transmit in the frequency band **301** may perform a narrowband LBT in one or more frequency subbands **302**. As an example, the sidelink UE may perform an LBT in the frequency subbands **302.sub.S2** during the LBT gap duration **310**. The LBT may be an energy detection-based CAT4 LBT as discussed above with reference to FIG. 1. If the LBT is a pass (e.g., when the measured channel signal energy is below an energy detection threshold), the sidelink UE may proceed to transmit SCI and sidelink data to a peer sidelink UE in the sidelink resource **306**. If the LBT fails (e.g., when the channel signal energy is above the energy detection threshold), the sidelink UE may refrain from transmitting in the sidelink resource **306**. As such, the LBT can operate to gate access or occupancy in a frequency subband **302.sub.S2** and to facilitate coexistence with other technologies sharing the frequency band **301**.

(56) The sidelink UE may transmit the SCI in the PSCCH **320** and the sidelink data (e.g., user information data) in the PSSCH **330**. The sidelink data can be of various forms and types depending on the sidelink application. For instance, when the sidelink application is a V2X application, the sidelink data may carry V2X data (e.g., vehicle location information, traveling speed and/or direction, vehicle sensing measurements, etc.). Alternatively, when the sidelink application is an IIoT application, the sidelink data may carry IIoT data (e.g., sensor measurements, device measurements, temperature readings, etc.). The sidelink UE may also transmit a HARQ ACK/NACK in the PSFCH **340**. The HARQ ACK/NACK may be a feedback for sidelink data received by the sidelink UE in an earlier sidelink resource **306**. The SCI can indicate a reservation for a next sidelink resource **306**. Thus, an intra-NR sidelink UE (e.g., a UE in the same NR-U sidelink system) may perform SCI sensing to determine whether a sidelink resource **306** is available or occupied for intra-NR sharing. For instance, if the intra-NR sidelink UE detected SCI indicating a reservation for the sidelink resource **306**, the intra-NR sidelink UE may refrain from transmitting in the reserved sidelink resource **306**. If the intra-NR sidelink UE determines that there is no reservation detected for a sidelink resource **306**, the intra-NR sidelink UE may transmit in the sidelink resource **306**. As such, SCI sensing can assist a UE in identifying a target frequency subband **302** to reserve for sidelink communication and to avoid collision (e.g., intra-NR collision) with another sidelink UE in the NR sidelink system. In some aspects, the intra-RAT sidelink UE

may be configured with a sensing window for SCI sensing or monitoring to reduce intra-NR collision.

(57) The SCI can also indicate scheduling information and/or a destination identifier (ID) identifying a target receiving sidelink UE for the next sidelink resource **306**. Thus, a sidelink UE may monitor SCIs transmitted by other sidelink UEs. Upon detecting SCI in a sidelink resource **306**, the sidelink UE may determine whether the sidelink UE is the target receiver based on the destination ID. If the sidelink UE is the target receiver, the sidelink UE may proceed to receive and decode the sidelink data indicated by the SCI.

(58) In some aspects, the scheme **300** is used for synchronous sidelink communication. In other words, the sidelink UEs are synchronized in time and are aligned in terms of symbol boundary, sidelink resource boundary (e.g., the starting time of sidelink resource **306**), LBT gap duration boundary (e.g., the starting time of the LBT gap duration **310**). The sidelink UEs may perform synchronization in a variety of forms, for example, based on sidelink SSBs received from a sidelink UE and/or NR-U SSBs received from a BS (e.g., the BSs **105** and/or **205**) while in-coverage of the BS. In some aspects, a sidelink UE in the system may be preconfigured with a resource pool **308** in the frequency band **301**, for example, while in a coverage of a serving BS. The resource pool **308** may include a plurality of sidelink resources **306** arranged as shown in the frame structure **304**. The BS can configure the sidelink UE with a resource pool configuration indicating resources in the frequency band **301** and/or the subbands **302**, the frame structure **304** (e.g., the LBT gap duration **310** and/or the sidelink resource **306**), and/or timing information (e.g., LBT gap duration **310** start and end boundaries).

(59) FIG. 4 illustrates a sidelink communication scenario **400** in a shared frequency band, according to aspects of the present disclosure. The scenario **400** may involve UEs such as the UEs **115** and/or **215** in a network such as the networks **100** and/or **200**. In particular, sidelink UEs may communicate and/or operate according to the scenario **400** to contend for access in a shared radio frequency band (e.g., in a shared spectrum or an unlicensed spectrum) for sidelink communication. The shared radio frequency band may be shared by multiple RATs as discussed in FIG. 2. In FIG. 4, the x-axis represents time in some arbitrary units, and the y-axis represents frequency in some arbitrary units.

(60) In the scenario **400**, a UE may communicate using a plurality of sidelink resources, as similarly discussed above with respect to the scheme **300**. The sidelink resources may include PSCCHs **420**, PSSCHs **430**, and PSFCHs **440**. The scenario **400** includes sidelink communications in the shared frequency band over a period of time including a plurality of slots (e.g., **414**, **416**). The time domain configuration of the scenario **400** may include periodic and/or semi-persistent PSFCH resources **440** including PSFCH instances **442**, **444**. The PSFCH resources **440** may be a global or common configuration for a plurality of UEs communicating in a cell and/or network, in some aspects. The PSFCH resources **440** may be used to transmit SL feedback information and/or to receive SL feedback information. In some aspects, SL feedback information may include hybrid automatic repeat request (HARQ) acknowledgement/non-acknowledgement (ACK/NACK) for one or more PSSCH instances, such as the first PSSCH **432** and/or the second PSSCH **434**. The periodicity of the PSFCH resources **440** may be referred to as a PSFCH period **412**. The PSFCH period **412** may be one or more slots, such as 1, 2, 4, 6, 8 and/or any other suitable number of slots. In the illustrated example, the PSFCH period **412** is four slots. In some aspects, a UE may determine whether there is SL feedback information to receive in a PSFCH resource, or whether there is SL feedback information to transmit in a PSFCH resource.

(61) The sidelink resources may be associated with or acquired by a LBT **460**. For example, the UE may perform a LBT to acquire a channel occupancy time (COT). If the LBT results in a pass, the UE acquires a COT during which the UE communicates in the first PSCCH **422** and the first PSSCH **432**. Following the first PSSCH **432**, the UE may be configured with a periodic and/or semi-persistent PSFCH resource or instance **442**. In some aspects, the PSFCH instance **442** may



result in a link switch and/or a gap in communications during the first COT. In some aspects, the gap in communications may exceed the configured COT maintenance threshold described above. Accordingly, the UE may refrain from transmitting and/or receiving during the following slot **414**. The UE may then perform a second LBT **462** during a second slot **416**. Based on the second LBT **462**, the UE may acquire a COT **464** during which the UE may communicate in a second PSCCH **424**, a second PSSCH **434**, a third PSCCH **426**, and a third PSSCH **436**. The UE may continue the COT **464**, without performing an additional LBT, between the PSSCH **434** and the PSSCH **436** if the gap between the PSSCH **434** and the PSSCH **436** is equal to or lower than the configured COT maintenance threshold. For example, the UE may continue to communicate during the COT **464** if the gap between sidelink communications is less than 25  $\mu$ s. In another example, the UE may continue to communicate during the COT **464** if the gap between sidelink communications is equal to or less than 16  $\mu$ s.

(62) The PSFCH resources **440** include a second PSFCH instance **444** following the third PSSCH **436**. In some aspects, there may be a gap between the third PSSCH **436** and the second PSFCH instance **444**. In some aspects, the gap may be greater than 16  $\mu$ s, or greater than 25  $\mu$ s. If the gap exceeds 25  $\mu$ s, the UE may be indicated or configured to perform an additional LBT to continue communicating during the COT **464**. In another aspect, the UE may perform an additional LBT to acquire or initiate a new COT before sidelink communications can resume. Further, in some aspects, the UE may not have PSFCH communications to transmit or to receive. However, the additional LBT would result in undesirable overhead and decreased throughput. Accordingly, the efficiency of the sidelink communications in the shared frequency band may decrease.

(63) The present disclosure provides systems, schemes, and mechanisms for maintaining COTs over PSFCH instances in sidelink shared frequency communications. In some aspects, mechanisms for maintaining COT's include a first wireless communication device indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one Symbol between a sidelink communication channel and a sidelink feedback instance. In some aspects, the sidelink feedback instance may be a PSFCH instance. In some aspects, the signal may include a cyclic prefix (CP). In some aspects, the CP may be referred to as a CP extension (CPE). In some aspects, transmitting the signal may include transmitting sidelink ACK/NACK in a PSFCH instance with a CPE extending at least partially within the at least one gap symbol. The second wireless communication device may transmit the signal in the at least one gap symbol such that a remaining gap between a PSSCH and a PSFCH communication is less than 25  $\mu$ s. In another aspect, the second wireless communication device may transmit the signal such that the gap between the PSSCH and the PSFCH is less than about 16  $\mu$ s. According to another aspect of the present disclosure, the first wireless communication device may indicate the second wireless communication device to transmit a filler signal or pattern signal in the at least one PSF see instance. For example, in some instances, the first wireless communication device may not expect to receive PSFCH communications from the second wireless communication device. Further, the first wireless communication device may not have sidelink feedback data to communicate in the PSFCH instance. Accordingly, the first wireless communication device may indicate the second wireless communication device to transmit the padding signal, where the padding signal is based on a PSFCH waveform. In some aspects, transmitting the padding signal may include transmitting a CPE with the PSFCH-based padding signal. In some aspects, the CPE may be transmitted in at least one gap symbol between the PSSCH and the PSFCH instance. According to another aspect of the present disclosure, a mechanism for maintaining a COT may include rate matching sidelink data to extend over the at least one gap symbol and/or the PSFCH instance.

(64) FIG. 5 is a diagram illustrating a COT maintenance scheme **500** for sidelink communications in a shared frequency band. Aspects of the present disclosure may be performed by a first wireless communication device and/or a second wireless communication device. For example, in one aspect, one or more actions of the scheme **500** may be performed by a first user equipment

communicating with a second user equipment. FIG. 5 shows a plurality of sidelink resources configured for sidelink communications between the first wireless communication device and the second wireless communication device the sidelink resources are distributed over a slot **510** the slot **510** includes a plurality of symbols **512**. As similarly illustrated in FIG. 4, the slot **510** may be a portion of a COT obtained by performing a LBT in the shared frequency band. The communications within the slot **510** include sidelink control information (SCI) **520**, PSSCH data **530**, PSFCH data **540**, automatic gain control symbols (AGC) **550**, and gap symbols **560**. For instance, the first symbol of the slot **510** includes a first AGC **552**. The first AGC **552** may include or be based on a copy of the signals, waveforms, and/or data in the immediately following symbol. The SCI **520** communicated during the slot **510** includes a first SCI **522** and a second SCI **524**. In some aspects, the first SCI **522** includes SCI-1. In another aspect, the second SCI **524** includes SCI-2. In some aspects, the first SCI **522** is communicated using PSCCH resources, and the second SCI **524** is communicated using PSSCH resources. The slot also includes a PSSCH communication **532**. The PSSCH communication **532** may include SL data, RRC information elements (IEs), media access control (MAC) IEs and/or control elements (CEs). The SL data may be communicated in one or more transport blocks (TBs).

(65) In some aspects, the resources for each of the SL communications may be configured for a SL resource pool. In some aspects, the SL resource pool may indicate time and/or frequency resources for each of a plurality of channels, such as the PSCCH, the PSSCH, and the PSFCH. In some aspects, the allocation of frequency resources may include one or more sets of resource blocks (RBs), one or more interlaces of RBs, one or more subchannels, and/or one or more partial RBs. In some aspects, the frequency resources may be different for different channels. For example, the SL resource pool may indicate a first subset of frequency resources for the SCI **520**, a second subset of frequency resources for the PSSCH communications **530**, and a third subset of frequency resources for the PSFCH communications **540**. In some aspects, the SL resource pool may include or indicate a first interlace of RBs for the PSSCH communications **530**, and a second interlace of RBs for the PSFCH communications **540**. Further, the UEs may be configured with a mapping scheme or configuration for mapping PSSCH resources to the PSFCH resources. For example, the PSFCH resources may be divided into subsets or portions, where each subset is allocated for a PSSCH communication **530** in a given PSSCH resource and/or slot.

(66) For PSFCH communications, a UE may be configured with a dynamic HARQ timeline, or a fixed HARQ timeline. For a dynamic HARQ timeline, the SCI in each slot may include a value of K1 indicating which PSFCH instance carries the SL feedback information for the associated PSSCH in a later slot. For example, a K1 value of 5 may indicate that the SL feedback information (e.g., ACK, NACK) for the associated PSSCH communication may be provided in a PSFCH resource 5 slots in the future. For a fixed HARQ timeline, a UE may be configured with a MinTimeGapPSFCH value, which indicates a minimum number of slots after the last slot of a PSSCH communication before the UE transmits the PSFCH.

(67) The slot **510** includes a PSFCH instance **542**. For example, the UEs may be configured with a periodic PSFCH resource that occurs once every n slots. In some aspects, n may be 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, and/or any other suitable number of slots. In some aspects, the value of n may be referred to as the PSFCH period, as explained above. Between the PSSCH communication **532** and the PSFCH resource **542** there is at least one gap symbol **562** and a AGC symbol **554**. In some aspects, the duration of the gap symbol **562** may be greater than a configured threshold for COT maintenance. For example, the duration of the symbol **562** may be greater than 25  $\mu$ s, and/or greater than 16  $\mu$ s. In the scheme **500**, the first wireless communication device indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit, with the PSFCH communication **542**, a signal in at least a portion of the gap symbol **562**. In the example shown in FIG. 5, the first wireless communication device indicates the second wireless communication device to add a CP extension (CPE) **572** to the AGC **554** to within at least a portion of the gap symbol **562**. The communication of the CPE **572**

reduces the duration of the gap **564** between the PSSCH **532** and the PSFCH instance **542**. In some aspects, the communication of the CPE **572** may reduce the duration of the gap **564** to lower than the configured COT maintenance threshold. For example, the second wireless communication device may communicate the CPE **572** such that the duration of the gap **564** is less than 25  $\mu$ s and/or less than 16  $\mu$ s. Thus, the first wireless communication device may continue to communicate using the COT in the following slot.

(68) In some instances, the PSFCH communication in the PSFCH instance **542** may include a SL ACK/NACK transmitted by the second wireless communication device to acknowledge reception or no reception of one or more PSSCH communications transmitted by the first wireless communication device. For example, in some aspects, the PSFCH communication may indicate SL ACK/NACK for one or more PSSCH instances preceding the PSFCH resource. In some aspects, the PSFCH communication in the PSFCH instance **542** may indicate ACK/NACK for each PSSCH communication in a PSFCH period. In some aspects, the PSFCH communication in the PSFCH instance **542** may indicate ACK/NACK for PSSCH communications over a plurality of PSFCH periods. In another aspect, the PSFCH communication in the PSFCH instance **542** may indicate ACK/NACK or other SL feedback information associated with the SCI **520**. For example, the first wireless communication device may indicate the second wireless communication device to transmit SL feedback information based on decoding at least one of the first SCI **522** or the second SCI **524**. Thus, if the second wireless communication device does not have PSFCH information to transmit in the PSFCH instance **542**, the second wireless communication device may transmit the SL feedback information in the PSFCH instance **542** based on decoding the SCI **522**, **524**.

(69) In another aspect, transmitting the PSFCH communication in the instance **542** may include transmitting a filler signal or padding signal in the PSFCH instance **542**. For example, if the first wireless communication device does not expect to receive SL feedback information in the PSFCH instance **542**, the first wireless communication device may indicate the second wireless communication device to transmit the padding signal in the instance **542**. The padding signal may be based on a PSFCH waveform. Accordingly, the second wireless communication device may transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal with the AGC **554** and the CPE **572** such that the padding signal, AGC **554**, and CPE **572** at least partially close or fill the gap **564** in communications between the PSFCH instance **542** and the PSSCH **532**. Accordingly, the COT is maintained such that the first wireless communication device may resume communications in a second slot following the PSFCH instance **542**. In some aspects, the first wireless communication device resuming communications in the following slot may include an additional CPE **574** in at least a portion of a second gap symbol **564** following the PSFCH instance **542**. Accordingly, the combination of the second wireless communication device's closing the first gap symbol **562** and the first wireless communication device closing the second gap symbol **564** may maintain the COT for additional PSSCH communications after the PSFCH instance **542**.

(70) FIG. **6** is a signaling diagram of a method **600** for wireless communication performed by a first UE (UE A) and a second UE (UE B). The UEs may be UEs **115** in the network **100** and/or UEs **215** in the network **200**. The method **600** may include aspects of the scheme **500** shown in FIG. **5**. The method **600** may include the UEs A and B communicating via a sidelink interface in a shared frequency band. For example, the method **600** may include communicating using a sidelink-unlicensed (SL-U) protocol. In some aspects, the UEs A and B may communicate using a PC5 interface. As mentioned above, to communicate in shared or unlicensed frequency resources, one or both of the UEs A and B may perform a clear channel assessment (CCA), such as a listen-before-talk (LBT) to acquire a set of time resources in a frequency band or subband. The time resources may be referred to as a channel occupancy time (COT).

(71) At action **602**, UE A performs an LBT to initiate or acquire a COT **610**. In some aspects, the LBT may be a CAT4 LBT with a random backoff period. In other aspects, the LBT may be a CAT2 LBT. Performing the LBT may include obtaining signal measurements for a configured period of

time. In some aspects, the period of time may be variable. For example, the period of time may include a random backoff period associated with a random backoff counter value. In another aspect, the period of time may be fixed. Based on the LBT, UE A initiates the COT **610**. The COT **610** may include a time period during which UE A may communicate with one or more UEs in the network, including UE B. In some aspects, the time period may be configured as a value of absolute time units, such as ms or  $\mu$ s. In another aspect, the time period may be configured as a value of frames, subframes, and/or slots.

(72) At action **604**, UE A transmits, to UE B, a SL communication including a PSCCH communication and a PSSCH communication. In some aspects, the PSCCH communication may include SCI. The SCI may be SCI-1 and/or SCI-2. In some aspects, the SCI may include an indication to UE B to transmit a signal to UE A during at least one gap symbol preceding a PSFCH resource. In other words, the SCI may indicate UE B to transmit the signal in the at least one gap symbol, where the at least one gap symbol is between the PSSCH communication and the PSFCH resource. The PSFCH resource may be a periodic and/or semi-persistent PSFCH resource scheduled for a period of time following the PSSCH communication. The PSFCH resource may be during the COT such that additional PSCCH and/or PSSCH resources may be used after the PSFCH resource if the COT is maintained.

(73) In some aspects, action **604** includes UE A indicating UE B to transmit a CPE with a PSFCH communication, with the CPE transmitted during the at least one gap symbol. The CPE may include an extension of an AGC symbol transmitted with ACK/NACK information associated with the PSSCH communication and/or one or more previous PSSCH communications. In another aspect, action **604** includes UE A indicating UE B to transmit a PSFCH-based padding signal with CPE to extend within the at least one gap symbol. For example, UE A may indicate UE B to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal based on UE A determining that no ACK/NACK information is expected from UE B in the PSFCH instance. In some aspects, action **604** includes UE A indicating UE B to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal in each of one or more PSFCH instances before  $n+K1$ . For example, the SCI transmitted at action **604** may include an indication of the value for  $n$  in addition to the indication to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal with CPE. In other examples, UE A may indicate UE B to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal only in the next PSFCH instance.

(74) In another aspect, action **604** may include UE A or UE B selecting a PSFCH frequency resource, or subset of frequency resources, to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal. For example, UE A or UE B may select a set of frequency resources for the PSFCH-based padding signal that are orthogonal to the resources used by other potential Tx-Rx pairs. In one example, UE A or UE B may select a set of frequency resources for the PSFCH-based padding signal based on the COT-initiating UE's (UE A) identifier. For example, UE A or UE B may select the set of frequency resources based on its own L1 identifier. In this regard, UE A or UE B may select a PSFCH resource block (RB) group, RB-set, and/or RB interlace based on UE A's ID. According to another aspect, UE A or UE B may be configured with a reserved PSFCH resource for transmitting the PSFCH-based padding signal. For example, UE A and/or UE B may be configured with a reserved cyclic shift (CS), RB group, and/or RB interlace for transmitting the PSFCH-based padding signal. In another aspect, UE B may randomly select a PSFCH RB group and/or RB interlace. In some aspects, the reserved frequency resources for the PSFCH transmission by UE B may be excluded from the PSFCH resource pool. In some aspects, the other UEs in the network transmitting SL feedback information (e.g., ACK/NACK) in the PSFCH instance with the PSFCH-based padding signal may all select ACK to transmit in the PSFCH instance. In another example, the other UEs transmitting SL feedback information in the PSFCH instance may all select NACK to transmit in the PSFCH instance.

(75) In another aspect, action **604** includes UE A indicating UE B to transmit ACK/NACK with CPE, where the ACK/NACK is associated with the PSCCH transmitted at action **604**. For example,

UE A may determine whether it expects PSFCH information from UE B and transmit, based on the indication, SCI in the PSCCH indicating UE B to transmit the PSFCH indicating ACK/NACK for the SCI. The SCI may indicate UE B to transmit the CPE along with the PSFCH.

(76) At action **606**, UE B transmits, and UE A receives, based on the indication of action **604**, at least one of: (1) a PSFCH with CPE, or (2) a PSFCH-based padding signal with CPE. In some aspects, the CPE is transmitted within at least a portion of a gap symbol between the PSSCH transmitted at action **604** and the PSFCH resource. For example, the CPE may be transmitted to cover a portion of a gap symbol between a final PSSCH symbol and the AGC symbol preceding the PSFCH symbol. For example, the transmission of the PSFCH and CPE/padding signal and CPE may be transmitted such that the gap between the PSCCH/PSSCH in action **604** and the communication of action **606** is less than 25 s. In another example, the gap may be less than 16  $\mu$ s. In some aspects, action **606** includes transmitting ACK/NACK for the PSCCH transmitted at action **604**. In another aspect, action **606** includes transmitting ACK/NACK for one or more previous PSSCH communications.

(77) At action **608**, UE A transmits, and UE B receives, a second SL communication including a second PSCCH and a second PSSCH. As illustrated in FIG. 6, actions **604**, **606**, and **608**, and their associated communications, are performed within the COT **610**. Accordingly, based on the indication transmitted at action **604** and the transmission by UE B at action **606**, the COT **610** is maintained such that a new LBT may not be performed. Thus, the remainder of the COT **610** may be used following the PSFCH instance by at least partially closing the link switch gap associated with the PSFCH instance. In some aspects, action **608** may include UE A transmitting a CPE in a gap symbol preceding the first PSCCH/PSSCH symbol after the PSFCH instance.

(78) FIG. 7 is a flow diagram illustrating a scheme **700** for COT maintenance for sidelink communications in a shared frequency band, according to aspects of the present disclosure. As will be understood, the scheme **700** may include aspects of the schemes **500** and/or **600**. For example, the scheme **700** may be performed by a first wireless communication device communicating with a second wireless communication device using a sidelink communication protocol. In some aspects, the scheme **700** may provide a decision architecture or protocol for selecting a COT maintenance mechanism. Aspects of the scheme **700** may be performed by a UE such as one of the UEs **115**, **215**. The scheme **700** may involve or be associated with a UE configuration. The UE configuration may include a set of rules or a hard coded protocol for maintaining a COT through a PSFCH resource.

(79) At action **702**, the UE determines whether the UE has SL feedback information to transmit in a PSFCH resource. In some aspects, the PSFCH resource may be in the middle of a SL TB burst. Accordingly, there may be additional time resources following the PSFCH resource that the UE may use for additional SL communications. Determining whether the UE has SL feedback to transmit may include determining whether the UE has received PSSCH in one or more slots during a PSFCH period associated with the PSFCH resource. If the UE determines that there is PSFCH to transmit, the UE may transmit, at action **704**, the PSFCH (e.g., ACK/NACK) in the PSFCH resource with a CPE at the beginning of the PSFCH. For example, the UE may transmit the PSFCH with CPE in at least one gap symbol preceding the PSFCH resource such that the remaining gap is equal to or lower than a configured threshold.

(80) At action **706**, the UE determines whether the UE expects to receive SL feedback information to receive from one or more other UEs in the PSFCH resource. Determining whether the UE has SL feedback information to receive may include determining whether the UE has transmitted, to one or more other UEs, PSSCH communications during the PSFCH period.

(81) If the UE determines that there is SL feedback information to receive during the PSFCH instance, the UE may indicate, at action **708**, the second UE transmitting the PSFCH to transmit the PSFCH with CPE within at least one gap symbol preceding the PSFCH resource, as explained above with respect to FIGS. 5 and 6. If the UE determines that there is no SL feedback information

to receive in the PSFCH resource, the UE may perform at least one of actions **710** or **712**. For example, in action **710**, the UE indicates the second UE to transmit a PSFCH-based padding signal in the PSFCH resource with CPE. Alternatively to action **710**, the UE may rate match a PSSCH communication preceding the PSFCH resource such that the PSSCH communication extends over the PSSCH resource and the intervening gap symbol. Aspects of action **712** are illustrated in FIGS. **8**, **9A**, and **9B** below.

(82) In another aspect, at action **714**, if the UE expects to receive SL feedback information in the PSFCH instance, the UE may alternatively determine to delay a PSFCH resource and/or the associated link switch until an end of a transmission burst. In some aspects, the UE may determine to delay the PSFCH instance or the communication of PSFCH until a PSFCH instance near the end of a COT. For example, in a fixed HARQ timeline, the UE may delay the PSFCH instance by setting MinTimeGapPSFCH to have a larger value. In an dynamic HARQ timeline, the UE may set K1 values so that the SL feedback information is communicated at the end of a data burst.

(83) FIG. **8** is a signaling diagram of a method **800** for wireless communication performed by a first UE (UE A) and a second UE (UE B). The UEs A and/or B may be UEs **115** in the network **100** and/or UEs **215** in the network **200**. The method **800** may include aspects of the schemes **500**, **600**, and/or **700** shown in FIGS. **5-7**. In particular, FIG. **8** may illustrate aspects of action **712** of the scheme **700**. The method **800** may include the UEs A and B communicating via a sidelink interface in a shared frequency band. For example, the method **800** may include communicating using a SL-U protocol. In some aspects, the UEs A and B may communicate using a PC5 interface. As mentioned above, to communicate in shared or unlicensed frequency resources, one or both of the UEs A and B may perform a clear channel assessment (CCA), such as a listen-before-talk (LBT) to acquire a set of time resources in a frequency band or subband. The time resources may be referred to as a channel occupancy time (COT).

(84) At action **802**, UE A performs an LBT to initiate or acquire a COT **610**. In some aspects, the LBT may be a CAT4 LBT with a random backoff period. In other aspects, the LBT may be a CAT2 LBT. Performing the LBT may include obtaining signal measurements for a configured period of time. In some aspects, the period of time may be variable. For example, the period of time may include a random backoff period associated with a random backoff counter value. In another aspect, the period of time may be fixed. Based on the LBT, UE A initiates the COT **810**. The COT **810** may include a time period during which UE A may communicate with one or more UEs in the network, including UE B. In some aspects, the time period may be configured as a value of absolute time units, such as ms or  $\mu$ s. In another aspect, the time period may be configured as a value of frames, subframes, and/or slots.

(85) At action **804**, UE A transmits, to UE B, a SL communication including a PSCCH communication and a PSSCH communication. In the method **800**, UE A rate matches the PSSCH communication to extend through a PSFCH resource scheduled during the COT **810**. In this regard, FIGS. **9A** and **9B** illustrate aspects of the PSSCH rate matching for COT maintenance. Referring to FIG. **9A**, a SL slot is shown which may be similar, in some aspects, to the slot **510** shown in FIG. **5**. In FIG. **9A**, the communications within the slot include SCI **920**, PSSCH data **930**, PSFCH data **940**, AGC symbols **950**, and gap symbols **960**. For instance, the first symbol of the slot includes a first AGC **952**. The first AGC **952** may include or be based on a copy of the signals, waveforms, and/or data in the immediately following symbol. The SCI **920** communicated during the slot includes a first SCI **922** and a second SCI **924**. In some aspects, the first SCI **922** includes SCI-1. In another aspect, the second SCI **924** includes SCI-2. In some aspects, the first SCI **922** is communicated using PSCCH resources, and the second SCI **924** is communicated using PSSCH resources. The slot also includes a PSSCH communication **932**. The PSSCH communication **932** may include SL data, RRC information elements (IEs), media access control (MAC) IEs and/or control elements (CEs). The SL data may be communicated in one or more transport blocks (TBs). The slot includes a PSFCH instance **942**, which may be referred to as a PSFCH symbol. The

PSFCH instance **942** is preceded by the AGC symbol **954** and a gap symbol **962**. The gap symbol **962** may be greater than a configured COT maintenance threshold. For example, the gap symbol **962** may have a duration longer than 16  $\mu$ s and/or longer than 25  $\mu$ s.

(86) Referring to FIG. **9B**, the UE may rate match the PSSCH communication **932** to include an extended PSSCH portion **945**. The extended PSSCH portion **945** includes rate matched PSSCH data in symbols previously configured or allocated as a PSFCH symbol or instance **942**, an AGC symbol **954**, and gap symbols **962**, **964**. Referring again to FIG. **7**, in some aspects, the UE may select action **712** instead of action **710** based on a configuration of the COT or UE configurations and/or capabilities with respect to COT sharing. For example, in some aspects, the second UE may not be configured to share the COT for transmitting SL feedback information. Accordingly, the UE may determine, based on UE configurations for COT sharing, to rate match the PSSCH instead of indicating the second UE to transmit a PSFCH with CPE and/or a PSFCH-based padding signal with CPE.

(87) Returning to FIG. **8**, at action **806**, UE A transmits, and UE B receives, a second PSSCH and PSCCH communication in the COT **810**. Accordingly, UE A may continue to communicate in the COT **810** without performing an additional LBT. In some aspects, the PSCCH transmitted at action **804** may include SCI indicating, to UE B, the rate matching behavior of UE A so that UE B can successfully receive and decode the PSSCH communication at action **806**.

(88) FIG. **10** is a block diagram of an exemplary UE **1000** according to some aspects of the present disclosure. The UE **1000** may be a UE **115** discussed above in FIG. **1** or a UE **215** discussed above in FIG. **2**. As shown, the UE **1000** may include a processor **1002**, a memory **1004**, a sidelink communication module **1008**, a transceiver **1010** including a modem subsystem **1012** and a radio frequency (RF) unit **1014**, and one or more antennas **1016**. These elements may be in direct or indirect communication with each other, for example via one or more buses.

(89) The processor **1002** may include a central processing unit (CPU), a digital signal processor (DSP), an application specific integrated circuit (ASIC), a controller, a field programmable gate array (FPGA) device, another hardware device, a firmware device, or any combination thereof configured to perform the operations described herein. The processor **1002** may also be implemented as a combination of computing devices, e.g., a combination of a DSP and a microprocessor, a plurality of microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in conjunction with a DSP core, or any other such configuration.

(90) The memory **1004** may include a cache memory (e.g., a cache memory of the processor **1002**), random access memory (RAM), magnetoresistive RAM (MRAM), read-only memory (ROM), programmable read-only memory (PROM), erasable programmable read only memory (EPROM), electrically erasable programmable read only memory (EEPROM), flash memory, solid state memory device, hard disk drives, other forms of volatile and non-volatile memory, or a combination of different types of memory. In an aspect, the memory **1004** includes a non-transitory computer-readable medium. The memory **1004** may store, or have recorded thereon, instructions **1006**. The instructions **1006** may include instructions that, when executed by the processor **1002**, cause the processor **1002** to perform the operations described herein with reference to the UEs **115** in connection with aspects of the present disclosure, for example, aspects of FIGS. **5-9B**.

Instructions **1006** may also be referred to as program code. The program code may be for causing a wireless communication device to perform these operations, for example by causing one or more processors (such as processor **1002**) to control or command the wireless communication device to do so. The terms “instructions” and “code” should be interpreted broadly to include any type of computer-readable statement(s). For example, the terms “instructions” and “code” may refer to one or more programs, routines, sub-routines, functions, procedures, etc. “Instructions” and “code” may include a single computer-readable statement or many computer-readable statements.

(91) The sidelink communication module **1008** may be implemented via hardware, software, or combinations thereof. For example, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be implemented

as a processor, circuit, and/or instructions **1006** stored in the memory **1004** and executed by the processor **1002**. In some instances, the sidelink communication module **1008** can be integrated within the modem subsystem **1012**. For example, the sidelink communication module **1008** can be implemented by a combination of software components (e.g., executed by a DSP or a general processor) and hardware components (e.g., logic gates and circuitry) within the modem subsystem **1012**.

(92) The sidelink communication module **1008** may be used for various aspects of the present disclosure, for example, aspects of FIGS. 5-9B. For instance, the sidelink communication module **1008** is configured to transmit, in a first portion of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before-talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI). The SCI may indicate a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH). In some aspects, the sidelink communication module **1008** is configured to perform the LBT in a shared radio frequency band (e.g., the frequency band **301**) within an LBT gap duration (e.g., the LBT gap duration **310**). For example, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to perform a CAT2 LBT, a CAT4 LBT, and/or any suitable type of LBT to initiate or acquire the COT. In some aspects, the sidelink communication module **1008** is configured to transmit the first SL communication may include transmitting SCI in a PSCCH and/or in a PSSCH. Further, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to transmit SL data in a PSSCH. In some aspects, the communication may occur in one or more slots within the COT. The slot may include one or more symbols allocated for the PSFCH resource. For example, the slot may include, or be configured with, following the PSSCH resources, at least one first gap symbol, at least one AGC symbol, at least one PSFCH symbol, and at least a further gap symbol. In some aspects, the SCI indicates a second wireless communication device to transmit ACK/NACK in the PSFCH resource or instance and a cyclic prefix extension (CPE) in the first gap symbol preceding the PSFCH resource. In other aspects, the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit a PSFCH-based padding signal in the PSFCH resource with a CPE in the first gap symbol. In some aspects, the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit ACK/NACK for the SCI in the first SL communication.

(93) In another aspect, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to receive, from the second wireless communication device in the shared frequency band, the signal during the at least one gap symbol. As mentioned above, the sidelink communication module **1008** may receive a PSFCH with CPE. In some aspects, the PSFCH may indicate ACK/NACK for one or more PSSCH communications in one or more PSFCH periods associated with the PSFCH resource. In some aspects, the PSFCH may indicate ACK/NACK for the first SL communication. For example, the PSFCH may indicate ACK/NACK for SCI included in the first SL communication.

(94) In another aspect, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to transmit, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication. In some aspects, the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource. For example, the first portion of the COT may be in a first slot within the COT, and the second portion of the COT may be in a second slot within the COT. In some aspects, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to transmit a PSCCH and/or a PSSCH communication. In this regard, based on receiving the signal during the at least one gap symbol, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to maintain the COT such that the first wireless communication device may resume communications within the COT after the PSFCH resource and without performing an additional LBT.

(95) According to another aspect of the present disclosure, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to perform a listen-before talk (LBT) in a shared radio frequency band to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT). For example, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to a CAT2 LBT, a CAT4 LBT, and/or any suitable type of LBT to initiate or



acquire the COT. Further, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to transmit, based on the LBT, a first SL communication in the COT, where the first SL communication is rate matched to occupy at least a portion of SL feedback resources during the COT. For example, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to transmit the first SL communication including SCI and SL data. The COT may include SL data resources and SL feedback resources. In some aspects, the SL feedback resources may include one or more PSFCH instances or symbols. In some aspects, transmitting the first SL communication may include transmitting SCI in a PSCCH and/or in a PSSCH. In a further aspect, the first SL communication may include a PSSCH communication. The sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to rate match at least a portion of the PSSCH communication to occupy at least a portion of the SL data resources and the SL feedback resources. For example, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to rate match the PSSCH communication to extend within at least one of a gap symbol, an AGC symbol, and/or a PSFCH symbol of the slot. Based on transmitting the rate matched first SL communication, the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to continue to perform SL communications in the COT in additional time resources. For example the sidelink communication module **1008** may be configured to communicate additional PSCCH and/or PSSCH communications in one or more slots in the COT following the SL feedback resources.

(96) As shown, the transceiver **1010** may include the modem subsystem **1012** and the RF unit **1014**. The transceiver **1010** can be configured to communicate bi-directionally with other devices, such as the BSs **105**. The modem subsystem **1012** may be configured to modulate and/or encode the data from the memory **1004** and/or the sidelink communication module **1008** according to a modulation and coding scheme (MCS), e.g., a low-density parity check (LDPC) coding scheme, a turbo coding scheme, a convolutional coding scheme, a polar coding scheme, a digital beamforming scheme, etc. The RF unit **1014** may be configured to process (e.g., perform analog to digital conversion or digital to analog conversion, etc.) modulated/encoded data (e.g., SCI, sidelink data, LBT starting point reservations) from the modem subsystem **1012** (on outbound transmissions) or of transmissions originating from another source such as a UE **115** or a BS **105**. The RF unit **1014** may be further configured to perform analog beamforming in conjunction with the digital beamforming. Although shown as integrated together in transceiver **1010**, the modem subsystem **1012** and the RF unit **1014** may be separate devices that are coupled together at the UE **115** to enable the UE **115** to communicate with other devices.

(97) The RF unit **1014** may provide the modulated and/or processed data, e.g. data packets (or, more generally, data messages that may contain one or more data packets and other information), to the antennas **1016** for transmission to one or more other devices. The antennas **1016** may further receive data messages transmitted from other devices. The antennas **1016** may provide the received data messages for processing and/or demodulation at the transceiver **1010**. The transceiver **1010** may provide the demodulated and decoded data (e.g., sidelink configuration, resource pool configuration) to the sidelink communication module **1008** for processing. The antennas **1016** may include multiple antennas of similar or different designs in order to sustain multiple transmission links. The RF unit **1014** may configure the antennas **1016**.

(98) In some aspects, the transceiver **1010** is configured to perform an LBT in a shared radio frequency band based on a first starting point of a plurality of starting points within an LBT gap duration and transmit, to a second UE (e.g., the UEs **115**, **215**, and/or **1000**), a first sidelink communication in the shared radio frequency band based on the LBT, the first sidelink communication including first SCI and first sidelink data, for example, by coordinating with the sidelink communication module **1008**.

(99) In an aspect, the UE **1000** can include multiple transceivers **1010** implementing different RATs (e.g., NR and LTE). In an aspect, the UE **1000** can include a single transceiver **1010** implementing multiple RATs (e.g., NR and LTE). In an aspect, the transceiver **1010** can include various components, where different combinations of components can implement different RATs.

(100) FIG. 11 is a block diagram of an exemplary BS **1100** according to some aspects of the present disclosure. The BS **1100** may be a BS **105** in the network **100** as discussed above in FIG. 1 or a BS **205** in the network **200** as discussed above in FIG. 2. As shown, the BS **1100** may include a processor **1102**, a memory **1104**, a sidelink configuration module **1108**, a transceiver **1110** including a modem subsystem **1112** and a RF unit **1114**, and one or more antennas **1116**. These elements may be in direct or indirect communication with each other, for example via one or more buses.

(101) The processor **1102** may have various features as a specific-type processor. For example, these may include a CPU, a DSP, an ASIC, a controller, a FPGA device, another hardware device, a firmware device, or any combination thereof configured to perform the operations described herein. The processor **1102** may also be implemented as a combination of computing devices, e.g., a combination of a DSP and a microprocessor, a plurality of microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in conjunction with a DSP core, or any other such configuration.

(102) The memory **1104** may include a cache memory (e.g., a cache memory of the processor **1102**), RAM, MRAM, ROM, PROM, EPROM, EEPROM, flash memory, a solid state memory device, one or more hard disk drives, memristor-based arrays, other forms of volatile and non-volatile memory, or a combination of different types of memory. In some aspects, the memory **1104** may include a non-transitory computer-readable medium. The memory **1104** may store instructions **1106**. The instructions **1106** may include instructions that, when executed by the processor **1102**, cause the processor **1102** to perform operations described herein, for example, aspects of FIGS. 5-9B. Instructions **1106** may also be referred to as code, which may be interpreted broadly to include any type of computer-readable statement(s) as discussed above with respect to FIG. 10.

(103) The sidelink configuration module **1108** may be implemented via hardware, software, or combinations thereof. For example, the sidelink configuration module **1108** may be implemented as a processor, circuit, and/or instructions **1106** stored in the memory **1104** and executed by the processor **1102**. In some instances, the sidelink configuration module **1108** can be integrated within the modem subsystem **1112**. For example, the sidelink configuration module **1108** can be implemented by a combination of software components (e.g., executed by a DSP or a general processor) and hardware components (e.g., logic gates and circuitry) within the modem subsystem **1112**.

(104) The sidelink configuration module **1108** may be used for various aspects of the present disclosure, for example, aspects of FIGS. 5-9B. For instance, the sidelink configuration module **1108** may be configured to transmit, to a UE (e.g., the UEs **115**, **215**, and/or **1000**), a sidelink configuration indicating a sidelink resource pool and/or a PSFCH configuration. The sidelink configuration may indicate time-frequency resources for a sidelink resource pool (e.g., the frequency band **301**, the frequency subbands **302**, the sidelink communication frame structure **304**, allowable LBT starting points within an LBT gap duration) and/or sidelink traffic priority classes. Mechanisms for configuring sidelink UEs for channel access in a shared radio frequency band and/or an unlicensed band are described in greater detail herein.

(105) As shown, the transceiver **1110** may include the modem subsystem **1112** and the RF unit **1114**. The transceiver **1110** can be configured to communicate bi-directionally with other devices, such as the UEs **115** and/or **1000** and/or another core network element. The modem subsystem **1112** may be configured to modulate and/or encode data according to a MCS, e.g., a LDPC coding scheme, a turbo coding scheme, a convolutional coding scheme, a polar coding scheme, a digital beamforming scheme, etc. The RF unit **1114** may be configured to process (e.g., perform analog to digital conversion or digital to analog conversion, etc.) modulated/encoded data (e.g., PDCCH, PDSCH, SSBs, sidelink configuration, sidelink resource pool configuration) from the modem subsystem **1112** (on outbound transmissions) or of transmissions originating from another source such as a UE **115** and/or UE **1000**. The RF unit **1114** may be further configured to perform analog beamforming in conjunction with the digital beamforming. Although shown as integrated together

in transceiver **1110**, the modem subsystem **1112** and/or the RF unit **1114** may be separate devices that are coupled together at the BS **105** to enable the BS **105** to communicate with other devices. (106) The RF unit **1114** may provide the modulated and/or processed data, e.g. data packets (or, more generally, data messages that may contain one or more data packets and other information), to the antennas **1116** for transmission to one or more other devices. This may include, for example, transmission of information to complete attachment to a network and communication with a camped UE **115** or **1000** according to some aspects of the present disclosure. The antennas **1116** may further receive data messages transmitted from other devices and provide the received data messages for processing and/or demodulation at the transceiver **1110**. The transceiver **1110** may provide the demodulated and decoded data to the sidelink configuration module **1108** for processing. The antennas **1116** may include multiple antennas of similar or different designs in order to sustain multiple transmission links.

(107) In an aspect, the BS **1100** can include multiple transceivers **1110** implementing different RATs (e.g., NR and LTE). In an aspect, the BS **1100** can include a single transceiver **1110** implementing multiple RATs (e.g., NR and LTE). In an aspect, the transceiver **1110** can include various components, where different combinations of components can implement different RATs.

(108) FIG. **12** is a flow diagram of a sidelink communication method **1200** according to some aspects of the present disclosure. Aspects of the method **1200** can be executed by a computing device (e.g., a processor, processing circuit, and/or other suitable component) of a wireless communication device or other suitable means for performing the steps. For example, a wireless communication device, such as the UEs **115**, **215**, and/or **1000**, may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the memory **1004**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to execute the steps of method **1200**. The method **1200** may employ similar mechanisms as in the schemes **500**, **600**, **700**, and/or **800** discussed above with respect to FIGS. **5**, **6**, **7**, and **8**, respectively. As illustrated, the method **1200** includes a number of enumerated steps, but aspects of the method **1200** may include additional steps before, after, and in between the enumerated steps. In some aspects, one or more of the enumerated steps may be omitted or performed in a different order.

(109) At block **1210**, a first wireless communication device transmits, in a first portion of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before-talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI). The SCI may indicate a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH). In some aspects, the method **1200** includes performing the LBT in a shared radio frequency band (e.g., the frequency band **301**) within an LBT gap duration (e.g., the LBT gap duration **310**). For example, the first wireless communication device may perform a CAT2 LBT, a CAT4 LBT, and/or any suitable type of LBT to initiate or acquire the COT. In some instances, the first wireless communication device may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to perform the LBT by measuring signal energy in the shared radio frequency band beginning at the first starting point and over a duration of a CCA slot (e.g., ending at a next starting point), comparing the channel signal measurement to a threshold, determining that the LBT is a pass (e.g., the channel is available) when the channel signal measurement is below the threshold, and determining that the LBT fails (e.g., channel is busy) when the channel signal measurement is above the threshold. In some aspects, transmitting the first SL communication may include transmitting SCI in a PSCCH and/or in a PSSCH. Further, transmitting the first SL communication may include transmitting SL data in a PSSCH. In some aspects, the communication may occur in one or more slots within the COT. The slot may include one or more symbols allocated for the PSFCH resource. For example, the slot may include, or be configured with, following the PSSCH resources, at least one first gap symbol, at least one AGC symbol, at least one PSFCH symbol, and at least a further gap symbol. In some aspects, the SCI

indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit ACK/NACK in the PSFCH resource or instance and a cyclic prefix extension (CPE) in the first gap symbol preceding the PSFCH resource. In other aspects, the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit a PSFCH-based padding signal in the PSFCH resource with a CPE in the first gap symbol. In some aspects, the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit ACK/NACK for the SCI in the first SL communication. The first wireless communication device may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to perform the actions of block **1210**.

(110) At block **1220**, the first wireless communication device receives, from the second wireless communication device in the shared frequency band, the signal during the at least one gap symbol. As mentioned above, receiving the signal may include receiving a PSFCH with CPE. In some aspects, the PSFCH may indicate ACK/NACK for one or more PSSCH communications in one or more PSFCH periods associated with the PSFCH resource. In some aspects, the PSFCH may indicate ACK/NACK for the first SL communication. For example, the PSFCH may indicate ACK/NACK for SCI included in the first SL communication. The first wireless communication device may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to perform the actions of block **1220**.

(111) At block **1230**, the first wireless communication device transmits, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication. In some aspects, the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource. For example, the first portion of the COT may be in a first slot within the COT, and the second portion of the COT may be in a second slot within the COT. In some aspects, transmitting the second SL communication may include transmitting a PSCCH and/or a PSSCH communication. In this regard, based on receiving the signal during the at least one gap symbol, at block **1220**, the first wireless communication device may maintain the COT such that the first wireless communication device may resume communications within the COT after the PSFCH resource and without performing an additional LBT. The first wireless communication device may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to perform the actions of block **1230**.

(112) FIG. **13** is a flow diagram of a sidelink communication method **1300** according to some aspects of the present disclosure. Aspects of the method **1300** can be executed by a computing device (e.g., a processor, processing circuit, and/or other suitable component) of a wireless communication device or other suitable means for performing the steps. For example, a wireless communication device, such as the UEs **115**, **215**, and/or **1000**, may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the memory **1004**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to execute the steps of method **1300**. The method **1300** may employ similar mechanisms as in the method **800** illustrated in FIGS. **8-9B**. As illustrated, the method **1300** includes a number of enumerated steps, but aspects of the method **1300** may include additional steps before, after, and in between the enumerated steps. In some aspects, one or more of the enumerated steps may be omitted or performed in a different order.

(113) At block **1310**, a first wireless communication device performs a listen-before talk (LBT) in a shared radio frequency band to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT). For example, the first wireless communication device may perform a CAT2 LBT, a CAT4 LBT, and/or any suitable type of LBT to initiate or acquire the COT. In some instances, the first wireless communication device may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to perform the LBT by measuring signal energy in the shared radio frequency band beginning at the

first starting point and over a duration of a CCA slot (e.g., ending at a next starting point), comparing the channel signal measurement to a threshold, determining that the LBT is a pass (e.g., the channel is available) when the channel signal measurement is below the threshold, and determining that the LBT fails (e.g., channel is busy) when the channel signal measurement is above the threshold. The first wireless communication device may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to perform the actions of block **1310**.

(114) At block **1320**, the first wireless communication device transmits, based on the LBT, a first SL communication in the COT, where the first SL communication is rate matched to occupy at least a portion of SL feedback resources during the COT. For example, the first wireless communication device may transmit the first SL communication including SCI and SL data. The COT may include SL data resources and SL feedback resources. In some aspects, the SL feedback resources may include one or more PSFCH instances or symbols. In some aspects, transmitting the first SL communication may include transmitting SCI in a PSCCH and/or in a PSSCH. In a further aspect, the first SL communication may include a PSSCH communication. The first wireless communication device may rate match at least a portion of the PSSCH communication to occupy at least a portion of the SL data resources and the SL feedback resources. For example, the first wireless communication device may rate match the PSSCH communication to extend within at least one of a gap symbol, an AGC symbol, and/or a PSFCH symbol of the slot. Based on transmitting the rate matched first SL communication, the first wireless communication device may continue to perform SL communications in the COT in additional time resources. For example, the first wireless communication device may communicate additional PSCCH and/or PSSCH communications in one or more slots in the COT following the SL feedback resources. The first wireless communication device may utilize one or more components, such as the processor **1002**, the sidelink communication module **1008**, the transceiver **1010**, the modem **1012**, and the one or more antennas **1016**, to perform the actions of block **1320**.

(115) Exemplary Aspects of the Disclosure

(116) Aspect 1. A method of wireless communication performed by a first wireless communication device, the method comprising: transmitting, in a first portion of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resource; receiving, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol; and transmitting, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.

(117) Aspect 2. The method of aspect 1, wherein the receiving the signal comprises receiving a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) signal and the signal, wherein the signal comprises a first cyclic prefix (CP) preceding the PSFCH signal within the at least one gap symbol.

(118) Aspect 3. The method of aspect 2, wherein the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit the signal such that a duration between an end of the first portion of the COT and a beginning of the signal is less than or equal to 25  $\mu$ s.

(119) Aspect 4. The method of any of aspects 2-3, wherein the transmitting the second SL communication comprises transmitting: a physical sidelink shared channel (PSSCH) signal in the second portion of the COT; and a second CP in a gap period between the PSFCH signal and the second portion of the COT.

(120) Aspect 5. The method of aspect 4, wherein the PSSCH signal comprises an acknowledgement/non-acknowledgement (ACK/NACK) for decoding the SCI.

(121) Aspect 6. The method of any of aspects 2-5, wherein the receiving the signal comprises receiving a PSFCH-based padding signal in the PSFCH resource and a first cyclic prefix (CP)

preceding the PSFCH-based padding signal in the at least one gap symbol.

(122) Aspect 7. The method of aspect 6, wherein the SCI indicates one or more PSFCH resources and a slot index, the one or more PSFCH resources including the PSFCH resource, and wherein the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal in each PSFCH resource of the one or more PSFCH occasions before a slot associated with the slot index.

(123) Aspect 8. The method of any of aspects 6-7, wherein the PSFCH resource is orthogonal to at least a second PSFCH resource for communication of PSFCH resources by a third wireless communication device.

(124) Aspect 9. The method of aspect 8, wherein the PSFCH resource is selected based on an identifier of the first wireless communication device.

(125) Aspect 10. The method of any of aspects 8-9, wherein the PSFCH resource comprises a reserved PSFCH resource.

(126) Aspect 11. A method of wireless communication performed by a first wireless communication device, the method comprising: performing a listen-before-talk (LBT) to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT); and transmitting, based on the LBT, a first sidelink (SL) communication in the COT, the first SL communication including SL communication information (SCI) and SL data, the COT including SL data resources and SL feedback resources, wherein the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the SL data resources and at least a portion of the SL feedback resources.

(127) Aspect 12. The method of aspect 11, wherein: the SL feedback resources comprise at least one gap symbol, at least one automatic gain control (AGC) symbol, and at least one physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) symbol; and the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the at least one gap symbol, the at least one AGC symbol, and the at least one PSFCH symbol.

(128) Aspect 13. The method of any of aspects 11-12, wherein the SCI indicates, to a second wireless communication device, a rate-matching behavior for the COT.

(129) Aspect 14. A first wireless communication device comprising a memory, a transceiver, and a processor in communication with the memory and the transceiver, wherein the first wireless communication device is configured to perform the steps of any of aspects 1-10.

(130) Aspect 15. A first wireless communication device comprising a memory, a transceiver, and a processor in communication with the memory and the transceiver, wherein the first wireless communication device is configured to perform the steps of any of aspects 11-13.

(131) Aspect 16. A non-transitory, computer-readable medium having program code recorded thereon, the program code comprising instructions executable by a processor of a first wireless communication device to cause the first wireless communication device to perform the steps of any of aspects 1-10.

(132) Aspect 17. A non-transitory, computer-readable medium having program code recorded thereon, the program code comprising instructions executable by a processor of a first wireless communication device to cause the first wireless communication device to perform the steps of any of aspects 11-13.

(133) Aspect 18. A first wireless communication device comprising means for performing the steps of any of aspects 1-10.

(134) Aspect 19. A first wireless communication device comprising means for performing the steps of any of aspects 11-13.

(135) Information and signals may be represented using any of a variety of different technologies and techniques. For example, data, instructions, commands, information, signals, bits, symbols, and chips that may be referenced throughout the above description may be represented by voltages, currents, electromagnetic waves, magnetic fields or particles, optical fields or particles, or any combination thereof.

(136) The various illustrative blocks and modules described in connection with the disclosure

herein may be implemented or performed with a general-purpose processor, a DSP, an ASIC, an FPGA or other programmable logic device, discrete gate or transistor logic, discrete hardware components, or any combination thereof designed to perform the functions described herein. A general-purpose processor may be a microprocessor, but in the alternative, the processor may be any conventional processor, controller, microcontroller, or state machine. A processor may also be implemented as a combination of computing devices (e.g., a combination of a DSP and a microprocessor, multiple microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in conjunction with a DSP core, or any other such configuration).

(137) The functions described herein may be implemented in hardware, software executed by a processor, firmware, or any combination thereof. If implemented in software executed by a processor, the functions may be stored on or transmitted over as one or more instructions or code on a computer-readable medium. Other examples and implementations are within the scope of the disclosure and appended claims. For example, due to the nature of software, functions described above can be implemented using software executed by a processor, hardware, firmware, hardwiring, or combinations of any of these. Features implementing functions may also be physically located at various positions, including being distributed such that portions of functions are implemented at different physical locations. Also, as used herein, including in the claims, “or” as used in a list of items (for example, a list of items prefaced by a phrase such as “at least one of” or “one or more of”) indicates an inclusive list such that, for example, a list of [at least one of A, B, or C] means A or B or C or AB or AC or BC or ABC (i.e., A and B and C).

(138) As those of some skill in this art will by now appreciate and depending on the particular application at hand, many modifications, substitutions and variations can be made in and to the materials, apparatus, configurations and methods of use of the devices of the present disclosure without departing from the spirit and scope thereof. In light of this, the scope of the present disclosure should not be limited to that of the particular aspect illustrated and described herein, as they are merely by way of some examples thereof, but rather, should be fully commensurate with that of the claims appended hereafter and their functional equivalents.

## Claims

1. A method of wireless communication performed by a first wireless communication device, the method comprising: transmitting, in a first portion of a slot of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol of the slot, the at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resource such that a remaining gap duration between an end of the first portion of the slot of the COT and a beginning of the signal is less than a threshold; receiving, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol; and transmitting, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the receiving the signal comprises receiving a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) signal and the signal, wherein the signal comprises a first cyclic prefix (CP) preceding the PSFCH signal within the at least one gap symbol.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the threshold is less than or equal to 25  $\mu$ s.
4. The method of claim 2, wherein the transmitting the second SL communication comprises transmitting: a physical sidelink shared channel (PSSCH) signal in the second portion of the COT; and a second CP in a gap period between the PSFCH signal and the second portion of the COT.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the PSSCH signal comprises an acknowledgement/non-acknowledgement (ACK/NACK) for decoding the SCI.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the receiving the signal comprises receiving a PSFCH-based

padding signal in the PSFCH resource and a first cyclic prefix (CP) preceding the PSFCH-based padding signal in the at least one gap symbol.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein the SCI indicates one or more PSFCH resources and a slot index, the one or more PSFCH resources including the PSFCH resource, and wherein the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal in each PSFCH resource of the one or more PSFCH occasions before a slot associated with the slot index.

8. The method of claim 6, wherein the PSFCH resource is orthogonal to at least a second PSFCH resource for communication of PSFCH resources by a third wireless communication device.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein the PSFCH resource is selected based on an identifier of the first wireless communication device.

10. The method of claim 8, wherein the PSFCH resource comprises a reserved PSFCH resource.

11. A method of wireless communication performed by a first wireless communication device, the method comprising: performing a listen-before-talk (LBT) to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT); and transmitting, in a first portion of a slot based on the LBT, a first sidelink (SL) communication the COT, the first SL communication including SL communication information (SCI) and SL data, the COT including SL data resources and SL feedback resources, wherein the SL feedback resources comprise at least one gap symbol of the slot, wherein the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the SL data resources and at least a portion of the SL feedback resources, the portion of the SL feedback resources comprising the at least one gap symbol of the slot.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein: the SL feedback resources further comprise at least one automatic gain control (AGC) symbol, and at least one physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) symbol; and the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the at least one AGC symbol, and the at least one PSFCH symbol.

13. The method of claim 11, wherein the SCI indicates, to a second wireless communication device, a rate-matching behavior for the COT.

14. A first wireless communication device, comprising: a memory; a transceiver; and a processor in communication with the memory and the transceiver, wherein the first wireless communication device is configured to: transmit, in a first portion of a slot of a channel occupancy time (COT) based on a listen-before talk (LBT), a first sidelink (SL) communication comprising SL communication information (SCI), the SCI indicating a second wireless communication device to transmit a signal in at least one gap symbol of the slot, the at least one gap symbol preceding a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) resource such that a remaining gap duration between an end of the first portion of the slot of the COT and a beginning of the signal is less than a threshold; receive, from the second wireless communication device, the signal during the at least one gap symbol; and transmit, in a second portion of the COT based on the LBT, a second SL communication, wherein the second portion of the COT is subsequent to the PSFCH resource.

15. The first wireless communication device of claim 14, wherein the first wireless communication device configured to receive the signal comprises the first wireless communication device configured to receive a physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) signal and the signal, wherein the signal comprises a first cyclic prefix (CP) preceding the PSFCH signal within the at least one gap symbol.

16. The first wireless communication device of claim 15, wherein the threshold is less than or equal to 25  $\mu$ s.

17. The first wireless communication device of claim 15, wherein the first wireless communication device configured to transmit the second SL communication comprises the first wireless communication device configured to transmit: a physical sidelink shared channel (PSSCH) signal in the second portion of the COT; and a second CP in a gap period between the PSFCH signal and the second portion of the COT.

18. The first wireless communication device of claim 17, wherein the PSSCH signal comprises an



acknowledgement/non-acknowledgement (ACK/NACK) for decoding the SCI.

19. The first wireless communication device of claim 14, wherein the first wireless communication device configured to receive the signal comprises the first wireless communication device configured to receive a PSFCH-based padding signal in the PSFCH resource and a first cyclic prefix (CP) preceding the PSFCH-based padding signal in the at least one gap symbol.

20. The first wireless communication device of claim 19, wherein the SCI indicates one or more PSFCH resources and a slot index, the one or more PSFCH resources including the PSFCH resource, and wherein the SCI indicates the second wireless communication device to transmit the PSFCH-based padding signal in each PSFCH resource of the one or more PSFCH occasions before a slot associated with the slot index.

21. The first wireless communication device of claim 19, wherein the PSFCH resource is orthogonal to at least a second PSFCH resource for communication of PSFCH resources by a third wireless communication device.

22. The first wireless communication device of claim 21, wherein the PSFCH resource is selected based on an identifier of the first wireless communication device.

23. The first wireless communication device of claim 21, wherein the PSFCH resource comprises a reserved PSFCH resource.

24. A first wireless communication device, comprising: a memory; a transceiver; and a processor in communication with the memory and the transceiver, wherein the first wireless communication device is configured to: perform a listen-before-talk (LBT) to initiate a channel occupancy time (COT); and transmit, in a first portion of a slot based on the LBT, a first sidelink (SL) communication in the COT, the first SL communication including SL communication information (SCI) and SL data, the COT including SL data resources and SL feedback resources, wherein the SL feedback resources comprise at least one gap symbol of the slot, wherein the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the SL data resources and at least a portion of the SL feedback resources, the portion of the SL feedback resources comprising the at least one gap symbol of the slot.

25. The first wireless communication device of claim 24, wherein: the SL feedback resources further comprise at least one automatic gain control (AGC) symbol, and at least one physical sidelink feedback channel (PSFCH) symbol; and the SL data is rate-matched to occupy the at least one AGC symbol, and the at least one PSFCH symbol.

26. The first wireless communication device of claim 24, wherein the SCI indicates, to a second wireless communication device, a rate-matching behavior for the COT.

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